

QA transcript — copy/paste: terminal owns the mouse by default (v1.0.21)

Revision: 1 **Last modified:** 2026-06-13T12:40:00Z **Run-id:** 2026-06-13-mouse-off-default **Feature shipped:** `scripts/tmux.conf.template` default set `-g mouse off` — native terminal selection (multi-line), right-click→Copy, and native scroll work everywhere (Linux + macOS); tmux mouse on demand via prefix `m`. **Anti-bluff authority:** §11.4 / §11.4.2 / §11.4.5 / §11.4.50 / §11.4.69 / §11.4.83.

This is the captured runtime evidence that the shipped feature works for the end user — not metadata, not config-only. Closure entry: `Fixed.md` A43.

1. Root cause proven at the wire level (the discriminator)

On attach, `mouse on` makes tmux emit mouse-tracking DECSET *enables* to the outer terminal, which suppresses the terminal's native selection + right-click→Copy. `mouse off` emits none. Captured over a real PTY attach:

```
mouse on -> mouse_decset_seen: [('1000','h'), ('1000','l'),
                                ('1002','h'),
                                ('1002','l'), ('1003','l'), ('1006','h'),
                                ('1006','l')] # 3 ENABLES
mouse off -> mouse_decset_seen: [('1000','l'), ('1002','l'),
                                ('1003','l'),
                                ('1006','l')] # 0
ENABLES
```

No tmux binding can intercept a terminal's right-click→Copy menu; letting the terminal own the mouse is the only way select/copy "always" works.

2. Layer-3 wire-level test (`scripts/tests/59_native_mouse_unobstructed.sh`)

Captured PASS (real PTY attach):

EVIDENCE: shipped conf default is `'set -g mouse off'` (terminal owns the mouse)
EVIDENCE: default attach emitted `0` mouse-enable DECSET (`?1000h/?1002h/?1006h`) — native selection + right-click→Copy + native scroll UNOBSTRUCTED

EVIDENCE: after 'prefix m' tmux emitted 3 mouse-enable DECSET –
tmux scrollback + drag-copy available on demand
PASS: 59 native terminal mouse is unobstructed by default (select
+ right-click→Copy + scroll), tmux mouse on demand via prefix m

RED→GREEN confirmed: against the prior mouse on default the same test
reported default attach emitted 6 mouse-enable DECSET ... tmux is
capturing the mouse and suppressing native selection and FAILED all
three contracts.

3. Determinism (§11.4.50) — test 57 (reload+select+copy+paste), the test hardened this cycle

CLEAN (real sequential suite condition): 57 PASS=10/10
FAIL=0
HOSTILE (continuous adversarial pbcopy noise): 57 PASS=8/8
FAIL=0 (part-D honestly SKIP-layer'd 2× on detected clipboard
contention)

Never false-PASS (PASS requires the real OS-clipboard token paste); never false-
FAIL (foreign clipboard overwrite → §11.4.3 SKIP-layer, not FAIL).

4. Full verification gate (scripts/setup.sh → scripts/ verify.sh)

SUMMARY: PASS=53 FAIL=0 SKIP=5
✓ ~/.tmux.conf installed

Includes test 59 PASS and test 17 T2.3: live server mouse = off by
default. The gate exposed the binary (PATH-export) only after GREEN — the
anti-bluff covenant in action (the prior run with FAIL=1 correctly REFUSED to
install).

5. Collateral-regression sweep (§11.4.92 Pass 2)

Tests 01–43, 47, 48 run twice, identical verdicts: **41 PASS / 4 SKIP / 0 FAIL**. No
collateral regression from the mouse-off change. Hostname-color (10/11/25/26) and
cross-platform parity (40) all PASS.

6. 4-layer coverage (§103)

Layer	Artifact	Result
1 source gate 3 runtime	verify.sh mouse off (terminal default) (^set -g mouse off)	✓ present + green

Layer	Artifact	Result
	scripts/tests/ 59_native_mouse_unobstructed.sh	✓ PASS (wire-level)
4 paired mutation	M-MOUSEDEFAULT (flip default → on)	catches via test 59 (validated post-commit on clean tree)
regression	tests 56/57/58 (on-demand path) + 17 + TMUX-CH-17	✓ green

Sources verified 2026-06-13

- tmux manual set-clipboard / mouse option semantics: <https://man.openbsd.org/tmux.1> (re-fetched 2026-06-13).